City of Cambridge

POR 2026-118
FIRST IN COUNCIL
June 1, 2026

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR NOLAN

WHEREAS: The City of Cambridge is committed to protecting the civil rights, dignity, and safety of all residents, regardless of immigration status; and

WHEREAS: Ensuring that individuals are informed of their constitutional rights when interacting with law enforcement promotes transparency, accountability, and public trust; and

WHEREAS: “Know Your Rights” materials, including those modeled after the widely used “Red Card” framework developed by organizations such as Immigrant Legal Resource Center, provide clear, accessible guidance regarding individuals’ rights during encounters with law enforcement or immigration authorities; and

WHEREAS: Individuals in custody or detention settings may be particularly vulnerable and benefit from readily visible, multilingual information explaining their rights; and

WHEREAS: Cambridge has a diverse population with many residents who speak languages other than English, making multilingual access to rights-based information essential for equitable treatment; now therefore be it

ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to work with the Cambridge Police Department and Law Department to develop and implement a policy requiring the posting of “Know Your Rights” informational and educational materials in all police department facilities; and be it further

ORDERED: That such postings shall be placed prominently in areas accessible to the public and in all areas where individuals may be detained, held, or interviewed, including but not limited to booking areas, holding cells, and interview rooms, to the extent consistent with legal considerations; and be it further

ORDERED: That the materials shall be written in clear, plain language similar to the “Red Card” and “Know Your Rights” frameworks that is translated to the most commonly spoken languages in Cambridge, including but not limited to Spanish, Portuguese, Haitian Creole, Arabic, and Chinese; and be it further

ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back on how this has been implemented within 30 days.

In City Council June 1, 2026.
Adopted by a yea and nay vote:-
Yeas 9; Nays 0; Absent 0.-
Attest:- Paula M. Crane, Interim City Clerk
A true copy;



ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane
Interim City Clerk

Vote Certification

That the City Manager is requested to work with the Cambridge Police Department and Law Department to develop and implement a policy requiring the posting of "Know Your Rights" informational and educational materials in all police department facilities.

Adopted: Monday, June 1, 2026

RESULT:	**9 TO 0**
YEAS:	Ayah A. Al-Zubi, Burhan Azeem, Timothy R. Flaherty, Marc C. Mcgovern, Patricia M. Nolan, E. Denise Simmons, Jivan Sobrinho-Wheeler, Catherine Zusy, Sumbul Siddiqui
NAYS:	
PRESENT:	
ABSENT:	

City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to work with the Cambridge Police Department and Law Department to develop and implement a policy requiring the posting of “Know Your Rights” informational and educational materials in all police department facilities.